

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 6

Group 6 Vocabulary

1. Admonish

Meaning: To warn or scold someone firmly.

Tip to remember: Think of a teacher saying, “I am warning you.” Admonish means to warn or scold.

Sentence: The professor admonished the students for submitting copied assignments.

2. Aesthetic

Meaning: Related to beauty, art, or pleasing appearance.

Tip to remember: Think of Instagram aesthetics: colors, design, and beauty.

Sentence: The building has both technical strength and aesthetic appeal.

3. Affectation

Meaning: Fake or artificial behavior meant to impress others.

Tip to remember: Affectation comes from “acting affected.” It is like pretending to be stylish or important.

Sentence: His foreign accent was just an affectation to impress people.

4. Alleviate

Meaning: To reduce pain, difficulty, or seriousness.

Tip to remember: Think of “a lift.” If something alleviates pain, it lifts some pain away.

Sentence: Proper planning can alleviate stress before exams.

5. Analogous

Meaning: Similar in some way; comparable.

Tip to remember: Analogous sounds like analogy. An analogy compares two similar things.

Sentence: The human brain is sometimes described as analogous to a computer.

6. Bolster

Meaning: To support, strengthen, or reinforce.

Tip to remember: A bolster is a pillow that supports your back. So bolster means to support.

Sentence: Strong evidence bolstered her argument.

7. **Chauvinistic**
Meaning: Showing excessive or aggressive loyalty to one group, country, or gender.
Tip to remember: Think of someone who blindly says, “My group is always superior.” That person is chauvinistic.
Sentence: His chauvinistic comments offended many people.
8. **Connoisseur**
Meaning: An expert judge in matters of taste, art, food, or quality.
Tip to remember: Think of someone who knows every detail about coffee, art, or music. That person is a connoisseur.
Sentence: He is a connoisseur of classical music.
9. **Dissemble**
Meaning: To hide one’s true feelings, motives, or intentions.
Tip to remember: Dissemble sounds like “disassemble.” You break apart the truth and hide the real meaning.
Sentence: The politician tried to dissemble when asked about the scandal.
10. **Dogged**
Meaning: Determined and persistent; not giving up easily.
Tip to remember: Think of a dog chasing a ball again and again. Dogged means persistent.
Sentence: Her dogged effort helped her improve her GRE score.
11. **Dupe**
Meaning: To trick or deceive someone; also, a person who is tricked.
Tip to remember: Dupe sounds like “duplicate.” A fake duplicate can dupe people.
Sentence: The fraudster duped many people into investing money.
12. **Empirical**
Meaning: Based on observation, experiment, or evidence.
Tip to remember: In engineering and science, empirical data comes from real experiments, not just theory.
Sentence: The researcher used empirical evidence to support the claim.
13. **Engender**
Meaning: To cause, produce, or give rise to something.
Tip to remember: Think of “generate.” Engender means to generate a feeling or result.
Sentence: Unfair rules can engender anger among students.
14. **Entitled**
Meaning: Believing one deserves special treatment or privileges.
Tip to remember: Think of someone saying, “I deserve this automatically.” That person feels entitled.
Sentence: The entitled student expected high marks without studying.

15. **Pertinacious**
Meaning: Very persistent; stubbornly holding to an opinion or goal.
Tip to remember: Pertinacious sounds like “persistent.” Both mean not giving up.
Sentence: His pertinacious pursuit of research finally led to publication.
16. **Presumptuous**
Meaning: Too confident or rude by assuming too much.
Tip to remember: Presumptuous comes from presume. If you presume too much, you may become rude.
Sentence: It was presumptuous of him to speak for the whole team.
17. **Probity**
Meaning: Honesty and strong moral principles.
Tip to remember: Think of “proper behavior.” Probity means moral honesty.
Sentence: The judge was respected for his probity.
18. **Proliferate**
Meaning: To increase or spread rapidly.
Tip to remember: Think of files multiplying quickly in your laptop. They proliferate.
Sentence: Online courses have proliferated in recent years.
19. **Specious**
Meaning: Seeming true or attractive but actually false.
Tip to remember: Specious sounds like “special,” but only looks special from outside; inside it is false.
Sentence: His argument sounded convincing, but it was specious.
20. **Spurious**
Meaning: False, fake, or not genuine.
Tip to remember: Spurious sounds like “suspicious.” A spurious claim is suspicious because it is fake.
Sentence: The article was based on spurious data.
21. **Subjective**
Meaning: Based on personal feelings or opinions rather than facts.
Tip to remember: Subjective comes from the subject, the person observing. It depends on the person.
Sentence: Beauty is often subjective.
22. **Subvert**
Meaning: To secretly weaken, destroy, or overthrow something.
Tip to remember: “Sub” means under. Subvert means to attack from underneath.
Sentence: Corruption can subvert public trust in institutions.
23. **Timorous**
Meaning: Fearful, nervous, or lacking courage.
Tip to remember: Timorous sounds like timid. Both mean fearful.
Sentence: The timorous speaker avoided eye contact with the audience.

24. **Tortuous**
Meaning: Twisting, complicated, or indirect.
Tip to remember: Tortuous sounds like “twistuous.” It means full of twists.
Sentence: The mountain road was narrow and tortuous.
25. **Tractable**
Meaning: Easy to control, manage, or deal with.
Tip to remember: Think of a tractor pulling something smoothly. Tractable problems are manageable.
Sentence: The problem became tractable after the professor explained the method.
26. **Transient**
Meaning: Lasting for only a short time; temporary.
Tip to remember: Think of transit. People in transit stay only briefly. Transient means temporary.
Sentence: The pain was transient and disappeared quickly.
27. **Ubiquitous**
Meaning: Present or found everywhere.
Tip to remember: Think of mobile phones; they are everywhere. They are ubiquitous.
Sentence: Solar panels are becoming ubiquitous in many cities.
28. **Underscore**
Meaning: To emphasize or highlight something.
Tip to remember: In writing, an underscore draws a line under a word to stress it.
Sentence: The accident underscores the need for better safety rules.
29. **Venal**
Meaning: Corrupt; willing to do wrong for money.
Tip to remember: Venal sounds like “sell.” A venal person can be bought with money.
Sentence: The venal official accepted bribes from contractors.
30. **Venerate**
Meaning: To deeply respect or honor someone.
Tip to remember: Think of respecting elders or great leaders. To venerate is to honor deeply.
Sentence: Many people venerate scientists who improve human life.